

Lesson 1: Simple Rhythm Understanding

- Focus: Establishing basic rhythmic fluency (pulse, subdivision, and beat) without assuming prior familiarity with standard Western staff notation.
- Core Feature Used: Toggleable alternative support modes, introductory video scaffolding, and offline PDF worksheet export.

1) Objective

Students will gain and develop a basic understanding of simple-meter rhythmic patterns (whole notes, half notes, quarter notes) by using Rhythm Reader with toggleable scaffolding to bridge the gap regardless of prior music reading background.

2) Pedagogical Rationale (Resist & Relate)

Traditional sight-reading tools operate on a privilege hazard, assuming all students enter the classroom already fluent in reading Eurocentric staff notation. This lesson resists notation supremacy by treating symbolic reading as something to be scaffolded through aural and physical practices rather than tested as an innate barrier to entry.

3) Lesson Flow:

- Step 1: Scaffolding via Introductory Video - Before touching the software, the class watches the TKTK-minute introductory video embedded in the app. This models how to internalize a steady pulse and clap or tap simple rhythms using multiple models (Takadimi syllable, traditional Western 1 and 2 and counting).
- Step 2: Configure Practice on Rhythm Reader.
 - Pre-generate an easy 4/4 exercise consisting of quarter and half notes.
 - Students open the app on their devices (their own or one provided to them). Those who need extra support can toggle the Takadimi syllable display or numeric grid options located at the top of the screen (these options are off by default to prevent cognitive overload).
 - Students practice clapping or tapping the generated line along with the app's aural playback mode.
- Step 3: Offline Equity Check
 - For students without reliable home internet or devices, the teacher uses the "Export to Worksheet" feature to generate printable offline practice sheets complete with the same Takadimi and numeric scaffolding, ensuring equity of access outside the classroom walls.